Without expressing a blunt political critique of either side, the location of the project and its attempt to forge a proxy wall presented the border as an area ripe for site-specific interventions that questioned the parameters of Cold War cultural understandings. According to Mesch, Kaprow levied an engagement with experiences that were denied comparison by the Wall. She notes, "*Sweet Wall* examined a 'natural framework' for the materials being manipulated in the performance, and made reference to the actual Wall, constructed of Soviet concrete. …. Kaprow examined the collectivized labour process contained in both state socialist and capitalist models."[22] The collective aims also included a call to draw close to the abandoned urban core along the Wall. West German police, who functioned as unforeseen and unknowing participants in the performance, questioned the staged disruption but ultimately deemed it beyond reproach. Kaprow later released an activity booklet of the project, presenting his claims as parody. The resulting *Sweet Wall*, though reduced in scope and size from its referent border wall, nonetheless existed within an orbit of scrutiny, surveillance, and play along the actual border. Kaprow attempted to scrutinize and mitigate the effects of the Wall through a performative duplication.[23]

A year later, in 1971, Christo and Jeanne-Claude, married artists responsible for immense environmental and site-specific artworks, began realizing a massive artistic undertaking to address Berlin's traumatized past and divided present: to wrap the ruined remains of the Reichstag, located just steps away from the Wall. The two artists, though born in Bulgaria and France, respectively, had resettled in the United States in 1964. The first idea for the Reichstag project came at the suggestion of an American historian, Michael Cullen, who lived in Berlin. Cullen sent Christo and Jeanne-Claude a postcard in August 1971 while they worked in Colorado on their *Valley Curtain*. They met several months later and began working on this idea for Berlin. According to Christo, the notion of the Berlin Wall also inspired him to consider the ramifications of the hardened border: "I was still a stateless refugee, without a passport or nationality, and I was dead scared."[24] Their first idea was to construct a fabric fence to run parallel and thus mirror the Berlin Wall, titled *A Curtain for West Berlin*. The project proposal was reminiscent of their *Running Fence* (1972–76), a twenty-four-mile zigzagging installation of a monumental but permeable boundary also made with fabric, running through the coastal hills of northern California to the Pacific Ocean.[25] In 1972, they envisioned *Wrapped Reichstag (Project for*